

NICOLAS DENNA

Strategic Commercial Director
Luxury Fashion & High-End
Textile

CONTACT

Tel Aviv, Israel · EU citizen
nicolas_denna@hotmail.com
+33 6 42 93 52 54
linkedin.com/in/nicolas-s-denna

CORE STRENGTHS

- P&L Management & Multi-Market Strategy
- Executive Committee & Stakeholder Mgmt
- B2B Sales Leadership & Key Accounts
- Premiumization & Margin Growth
- Asian Market Entry & Expansion
- Creative–Commercial Alignment
- AI, Phygital & Fashion-Tech
- Organizational Transformation

LANGUAGES

Italian	Native
French	Native
English	Fluent
German	Intermediate
Japanese	Basic

EDUCATION

Global MBA — AI & Entrepreneurship
Tel Aviv University, Collier School · 2025–26

BSc, Business Administration
Carlo Cattaneo University (LIUC) · 2002–07

Exchanges: CUHK Hong Kong · Hosei Tokyo (Japan Govt. Scholarship) · Lehigh, USA (Iacocca)

TOOLS

CRM · SAP / Industrial ERPs · Data Analysis · AI, Coding & Digital Fashion Tools

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Commercial leader with 15+ years driving growth across luxury fashion and high-end textile in Europe and Asia — including six years as Commercial Director of **External Activities** at **Hermès Textile Division**, on the Business Unit Executive Committee. Proven builder of commercial functions, elite sales teams and premium client portfolios; equally strong on P&L rigor, margin and the creative-commercial bridge. Now completing a Global MBA in AI & Entrepreneurship, bringing a rare fusion of luxury operational excellence and next-generation technology. Above all, a lifelong passion for textile — its complexity, its materials and its makers — drives everything I do. Philosophy: *keep the know-how, make it shine.*

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- **Hermès pedigree** — six years as Commercial Director, External Activities, on the Business Unit Executive Committee of Hermès Textile Division.
- **Scale & growth** — ran a ~€30M commercial P&L across four Asian offices; grew turnover **+40%** at Bonotto.
- **Luxury × technology** — founded a phygital B2B platform with a **3D digital-twin showroom** — 27 Italian brands, ~50 agents, **3.4× average order value**.
- **Strategic builder** — created new business lines from scratch and re-engineered client portfolios toward a premium core (**300 → 20** accounts), consistently lifting service and margin.

A visionary, high-standards leader and a natural bridge between creative and commercial — known for energizing teams with fresh, out-of-the-box thinking.

EXPERIENCE

Founder | Brand Selection

International · 2024 – Present

Early-stage B2B platform helping Made-in-Italy fashion SMEs scale internationally in the phygital era.

- Signed **27 Italian SME brands** and built a network of **~50 agents** across Italy, the EU and beyond onto a B2B marketplace.
- Designed and built a **phygital sales process**, including a **digital-twin 3D gallery** for a hybrid physical-plus-digital purchase journey.
- Lifted average order value from **€250 to €850 (3.4×)**, with marketplace conversion of **~30%** vs a ~2.5% industry benchmark.
- Self-taught **coding** and earned multiple **AI certifications** (sales automation, AI-assisted presentations), applied to real commercial workflows.

Commercial Director — External Activities | Hermès Textile Division (HTH)

Pierre-Bénite, France · 2019 – 2025

Owned the P&L for External Activities — external commercialization of the output of 8 Hermès-owned textile factories (finished accessories, fabric, semi-finished), a high-margin business, as a member of the Business Unit Executive Committee.

- Launched a new fashion textile accessories department, scaling revenue from **€100K to €2M (20×)**.
- Redesigned the client model, concentrating accounts from **~300 to 20** — lifting service levels and margin while reducing complexity.
- Led a **~13-person commercial organization** (4 sales directors, US & Paris offices, Customer Service, Sampling) plus a worldwide agent network.
- Cross-skilled the team into hybrid commercial-technical roles and opened structured collaboration with the Design department.
- Cut cost base (tradeshows, sampling) while protecting margin; delivered rigorous financial reporting and industrial forecasting across all 8 sites.

Director of Sales & Management, Asia | Zegna Baruffa Lane

Borgosesia

Biella, Italy · 2018 – 2019 · Reported to CEO

- Led a ~**€30M** Asian business across 4 offices (China, Japan and beyond) with a team of 10+.
- Consolidated market share and diversified the client portfolio; introduced CRM and digital sales for high-end Asian luxury segments.

Sales Manager — France, Scandinavia, Benelux & Australia | Bonotto (Ermenegildo Zegna Group)

Vicenza, Italy · 2015 – 2018

- Grew turnover by **40%** across four markets; deep expertise in exclusive fabric development (Jacquards, Rachels, shuttle & hand looms) and designer/buyer relationships.

Business Development & Europe Sales Manager | Canclini Group · Como, Italy · 2013–2015. Built European B2B distribution (Profilo Tessile); developed Far-East mill partnerships (Thailand, Vietnam).

Country Manager, India | Opto-Engineering · Pune, India · 2010–2013. Founded the Indian representative office; scaled BD for industrial AI-vision systems.

Co-Founder | General-Oxo · Chiasso, Switzerland · 2007–2010. Co-founded a commodity-trading startup in bulk petrochemicals.